Victor David Bernal Pavas

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Education

University of Houston, Houston, TX — August 2022–Present
Ph.D. in Economics, expected 2027

Universidad EAFIT, Medellín, Colombia — 2019–2020
M.Sc. in Economics, *with honors*

Universidad de Antioquia, Medellín, Colombia — 2012–2017
Bachelor's Degree in Economics, *with honors*

Research Interests

Urban Economics, Transportation Economics, Public Economics, Environmental Economics, Applied Microeconomics.

Publications

Bernal, D., García, G. A., and Pérez Pérez, J. "Better or Worse Job Accessibility? Understanding Changes in Spatial Mismatch: Evidence from Medellín, Colombia." *Journal of Transport Geography*, 128, 104341, 2025.

Working Papers

Less Traffic, Higher Tolls: Optimal Congestion Pricing under Remote Work and Traveler Heterogeneity
Job Market Paper

From Conflict to Human Capital? Evidence from Colombia's Peace Process
Working Paper

The Effect of Policy Variation on Urban Density: The Consequences of Crossed Borders for Cities
With Steven Craig, Edward Hoang, and Steven Bond-Smith.

Teaching Experience

University of Houston, Houston, TX — August 2022–Present

Instructor

- Principles of Microeconomics

Teaching Assistant

- Ph.D. Urban Economics
- Introduction to Econometrics
- Social Economy and Enterprise Academy Internship Program
- History of Economic Doctrine
- Intermediate Microeconomics

Research and Professional Experience

Consultant, Inter-American Development Bank – Project Effectiveness Evaluation at IDB Invest December 2021–August 2022

Research Assistant, Johns Hopkins University July 2021–July 2022

- Research assistant for Professor Luis Quintero.

Research Assistant, Harvard Business School January 2021–February 2022

- Research assistant for Professor Jorge Tamayo.

External Consultant, Banco de México October 2020–April 2021

- Research assistant for Jorge Pérez.

Research Assistant, Universidad EAFIT January 2019–July 2020

- Research assistant for Professor Gustavo García.

Presentations and Summer Schools

- "Less Traffic, Higher Tolls: Optimal Congestion Pricing under Remote Work and Traveler Heterogeneity.' North American Regional Science Council (NARSC), Philadelphia, November 11–14, 2026. *Scheduled presentation; Graduate Student-Author Paper Competition finalist.*
- Participant, Price Theory Summer Camp, University of Chicago, June 2025.
- "Better or Worse Job Accessibility? Understanding Changes in Spatial Mismatch at the Intra-urban Level in Medellín." Latin American Economic Association (LACEA), November 2023.
- "Better or Worse Job Accessibility? Understanding Changes in Spatial Mismatch at the Intra-urban Level in Medellín." European Regional Science Association (ERSA), online conference "Spatial Challenges for the New World," August 26, 2020.

Awards and Honors

- **Finalist, NARSC Graduate Student-Author Paper Competition (2026).** North American Regional Science Council.
- Master's thesis received academic distinction from Universidad EAFIT.
- Bachelor's thesis received academic distinction from Universidad de Antioquia.
- Media coverage of undergraduate thesis: El Colombiano; UDEA; El Tiempo.
- The undergraduate thesis formed the basis of a successful legal challenge to Colombia's gasoline surcharge tax. In 2019, the Constitutional Court ruled the taxable base unconstitutional following a lawsuit filed by the thesis authors based on the study's findings.

Skills

Software: Stata, R, ArcGIS, Python, EViews, MATLAB, LaTeX, Microsoft Office.

Languages: Spanish, native; English, fluent; French, intermediate.

References

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Fan Wang
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